

MINUTES

A **Committee of the Whole Meeting** is held **May 8, 2023** and scheduled to begin at 5pm in the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall as well as on Zoom and viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 15 and Verizon Channel 45.

The Purpose of this Meeting is:

1. As approved by the School Committee on February 1, 2023 (2023-3)
The Evaluation Subcommittee agreed to meet to review and develop the process for the 2022-23 Superintendent Evaluation
2. As approved by the Evaluation Subcommittee on Thursday February 16, 2023:
 - a. Superintendent to present her Self-Evaluation to the Committee of the Whole
 - b. Presentation of the Evaluation Template and Instructions to be given to School Committee Members by the Evaluation Subcommittee.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn opens the meeting.

Member Ruseau issues Roll Call for Attendance of Members. All members are present and in person, with the exception of Member Kreatz, who is participating remotely via Zoom.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn turns the floor over to Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

Dr Marice Edouard-Vincent shares that she is presenting her data a little earlier and looks forward to presenting under the new format. She comments there are only 6 weeks left to the academic year. As she gathered data and reflected on the past year, there is so much to be proud of and during the most difficult times, there were many lessons learned from crises. In reflection, she comments that she has grown both professionally and personally this past year. She is determined to stay focused on what is important and positive - namely the students and staff. The Medford Public Schools is currently at an important crossroads and through thoughtful community and family collaboration, we will continue to improve and thrive as a district.

The following brief highlights are provided:

The Medford Public Schools continue to be an inclusive school district, rich in history and diversity, which offers many educational opportunities for the students. Parents and caregivers are encouraged to collaborate and partner in their students' educational processes.

Dr Edouard-Vincent's A.C.E.S.'s of Achievement, Collaboration, Equity and Support guide her in her duties daily. Additionally, social emotional learning continues to be a cornerstone of the district, along with responsive classroom and restorative practices.

This year additional guidance counselors, social workers adjustment counselors, school psychologists, teachers and many more were hired.
We joined the Sandy Hook Promise to teach the students to start with 'Hello, See Something, Say Something initiative.

The Say Something Anonymous Reporting system was implemented in an effort to empower everyone - students and staff to help create change and promote safer schools.

A Ten-Point action plan was also implemented for safety, transparency, culture, climate and accountability.

Updating the handbook and implementing new hall and bathroom passess for students.

Viewings of Screenagers were offered for Middle School students and parents to develop awareness of too much screen time.

In her practice, she continues to bring an equity lens to all the work she does. She stands in agreement with a quote from Maya Angelou. "In diversity, there is beauty and there is strength". In Medford there is so much beautiful diversity and strength and she continues to work and support Medford Public Schools work on race equity and diversity across the district.

She continues to serve on the Melrose-Wakefield Hospital, Tufts Medical Board of Trustees as well as a member of District Attorney Marian Ryan's Anti-Hate, Anti-Bias task force.

In closing, the 'C' of A.C.E.'s, represents Collaboration without which, along with the thought partners of her senior leadership team, Dr. Peter Cushing, Suzanne Galusi, Joan Bowen and Medford Public Schools administrators, this work could not exist. She is grateful to have such a talented team to work collaboratively with and on behalf of Medford Public Schools, staff and community.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent takes the school committee members through her self evaluation based on events from June 2022 through to July 2023, and asks Dr. Cushing to facilitate the slide presentation of her Evaluation Evidence 2022-2023. She asks that the school committee members refer to the Superintendent's Goals SY22-23 document and use the link (in the handout) to access the goals that were established.

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent continues and comments that the self-evaluation is based on her goals, which she will share (*in due course*), as well as shares that all the work is connected to the district's strategic plan. She directs the school committee to the newly adopted MPS District Strategy for Improvement Document (Strategic Plan- as approved by the Medford School Committee on June 7, 2021), and notes that this is not a final document but a living document that will continue to be revised and updated. and provides the blueprint for the district's staff to achieve the mission of Medford Public Schools.

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent goes on to share that the following portion depicts the three goals that the Superintendent selected for SY 2022-2023.

The first overarching goals are the District Improvement Goals, followed by the Student Learning Goal, and lastly the Professional Practice Goal.

District Improvement Goals:

During the school year 2022 - 2023 the Medford Public Schools will improve the systems and structures that directly impact student services and operations. Improved outcomes or plans to

improve outcomes will be seen in student transportation, communications, and facilities operations.

Goal:

- Maintain a learning environment built upon the pillars of Safety, Equity, & Consistency.
- Create a culture that values consistent communication.
- Create structures that promote healthy transportation to school

A key safety structure that took place this school year was the arrival and dismissal changes at MHS. A new traffic pattern and a new drop-off system were implemented in the West Courtyard. This new traffic pattern has eliminated traffic congestion at the high school and it has created a safer environment for our students who walk home. In total, dismissal takes about 15 minutes for nearly 1300 students as opposed to nearly 35 minutes when using the previous system.

Key Actions:

1. Establish modern and accessible bicycle racks at schools.
2. Leverage partnerships with Safe Routes to School for walking school buses, bicycle lanes, and other options to reduce carbon and promote student welfare.
3. Consistent communication with families across all schools and student services such as athletics, counseling, career services, and student governance.
4. A school bus RFP that examines busing options beyond the MBTA.
5. Convene the Capital Planning Committee to examine building systems and create a replacement timeline.
6. Fully collaborate with MSBA (Massachusetts School Building Authority) to improve facilities and building systems.

The status of the proposed outcomes are as follows:

Proposed Outcomes:

- Bicycle racks updated at the middle and high school complexes.
 - o We are currently designing new bike racks. Our Metal fab are doing the design and fabrication of the pipes. Our CCI students will be doing the excavation and installation.
- Walking school bus routes
 - o National Walk,Bike, & Roll to School Day
- Bicycle lanes painted on city streets and school access roads.
 - o This will be finalized when Winthrop street is completed. (In progress)
- Purchase a communication platform that is used regularly by all schools and student servicing groups (Talking Points, Smores, etc).
 - o We have 50 licenses for Smores to be implemented August-September 2023 and we are actively using Talking Points districtwide.
- Launch of a new district smartphone app for the MPS website
 - o April 3, 2023 SC Presentation
- School bus contract that responds to student transportation needs.
 - o Ongoing
- Capital Planning Committee reviews at each school.
 - o Security Upgrades and Air Conditioning review across district
- Climate and Culture Assessment at MS & HS
 - o Panorama Survey will be administered on Thursday, May 11, 2023 to students.

Student Learning Goal:

Assessing early literacy skills and implementing interventions in literacy to improve outcomes by deepening teacher and principal knowledge of early literacy practices, while maintaining a District-Wide focus on Instruction and Assessment, through the continued use of NWEA MAP. (This is a continuation of last year's goal.)

The following key actions were achieved:

Key Actions:

1. Support the development and implementation of an effective early literacy program.
2. Full adherence to the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education Department's dyslexia guidance through the implementation of the Enhanced Core Reading Instruction (ECRI) program.
3. ECRI implementation during Tier 1 ELA blocks in all grades K-2 classrooms district-wide.
4. Continued partnership with HILL for Literacy throughout the 2022-2023 school year. This embedded PD model will ensure teachers are getting sustained monthly training and coaching that will enhance and grow their instructional practice. Newly Implemented this year.
5. Continued use of NWEA MAP (Northwest Evaluation Association Measures of Academic Progress) Assessment System.
6. Core Program Review with HILL for Literacy 4 K-2 Teachers have embraced ECRI and have seen progress in their students' literacy skills. The HILL for Literacy has provided ongoing support including demo lessons, one on one coaching, and professional development courses. At all grade levels, usage of the NWEA Map Assessment tool has allowed for the intentional analysis of literacy outcomes at the middle of year (MOY) and end of year (EOY).

The status of the proposed outcomes are as follows:

Proposed Outcomes:

- Full implementation of ECRI across all K-2 classrooms-Yes, it is fully implemented.
 - o Yes, ECRI is fully implemented in MPS. In addition, Grade 3 teachers have been trained this year so they have a greater understanding of the instruction their students have received K-2.
- Visible implementation of the Science of Reading best practices during literacy blocks and through conducting early literacy learning walks districtwide
 - o Principals and HILL for Literacy consultants complete this on monthly rounds.
- Intentional analysis of literacy outcomes at the middle of the year (MOY) and end of the year (EOY)
 - o This is done through multiple measures (ECRI, DIBELS, and MAP Growth) Student supports are analyzed and adjusted as a result of this benchmark data
- New Early Literacy Program selected -
 - o The Literacy Screening Team are still vetting the 3 programs (Wonders, McGraw Hill- MyView Literacy, Savvas, and IntoReading, Houghton Mifflin) Publisher and User Roundtable Session is scheduled for May 18th with a selection of the program by May 30th. Accountability
- NWEA MAP growth metric, 100% of all students at the 4 elementary schools in the aggregate will demonstrate growth at the 50th percentile or higher based on RIT (Rasch Interval Unit Scale) Scores* (Grades K-5)
- The assessment window closes on June 7th. She will have this data by June 9th as it takes 24

hours for the data to turn over after the window closes.

- Grades 6-10; 100% of all students at all schools in the aggregate will demonstrate growth at the 50th percentile or higher based on RIT Scores.
- The assessment window closes on May 17th. I will have this data 24-48 hours after the window closes.
- 65% of students will meet or exceed their projected growth targets on the NWEA MAP Assessments by Spring of 2023.
- She will share reports on this for Winter progress on Monday, May 15th by Ms. Galusi. She will have a few samples to reference.

Professional Practice Goal: Leading Now- Sessions and M.A.S.S. Racial, Equity, Diversity & Inclusion (REDI) Sessions

Further develop skills in strategy development, data analysis, instructional leadership and districtwide communications through participating in Superintendent-level professional development sessions through Leading Now and M.A.S.S. REDI.

M.A.S.S. REDI Group and Leading Now Cohort

Dr. Edouard-Vincent has continued with both organizations for the second year of professional development. Last year was the pilot year and this year the work has gotten deeper with M.A.S.S. REDI Group. The focus of this affinity group is Racial Equity, Diversity and Inclusion. Meeting monthly on zoom for two-hour sessions, participating Superintendents shared problems of practice and addressed current equity challenges facing their districts. This cohort will continue to meet virtually over the next year.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent is also actively involved in the Leading Now Cohort, a multi-state initiative tasked with addressing the impact of the current political climate on their school districts. The cohort will meet virtually as well as in-person over the next year.

Attached links are referenced for:

- M.A.S.S. REDI Group
- Leading Now

Key Actions:

1. Attend monthly Affinity Group and monthly (REDI) Sessions via Zoom and in-person.
2. Co-facilitating on Medford's Race, Equity, Task Force (RETF) meetings monthly.
3. Co-presenting on panels and advocating for students in the role of the Superintendent as a champion for REDI. Providing timely feedback during these panels or consultancy sessions.
4. Consult with fellow superintendents, mentors, and collaborators as needed.

The status of the proposed outcomes are as follows:

Proposed Outcomes:

- Further leverage the expertise and collective knowledge of superintendents across the State and nationally
 - o Ongoing work

- Seek input and incorporate suggestions from RETF
 - o Explicit RETF work was on hold, due to other high priority needs. It is our goal to relaunch with expanded student voice for SY 23-24. 6 Leading and learning about (REDI), providing mentorship and collaboration within both networks.
 - o Ongoing work
- Further partnership and collaboration with Middlesex County District Attorney's Office
 - o Ongoing partnership

Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education Superintendent's Evaluation

Standard I: Instructional Leadership

The educational leader promotes the learning and growth of all students and the success of all staff by cultivating a shared vision that makes powerful teaching and learning the central focus of schooling.

(Focus Indicators: I-B Instructional Leadership, and I-E Data-Informed Decision Making)

- Dr. Edouard-Vincent demonstrates sound instructional leadership skills. Next year there will be a substantive change to the 9th Grade Rotation at MHS. As part of the 9th Grade Career, Technical Education (CTE-vocational), MPS will be offering an arts/music rotation for our students who choose to be more engaged in the Arts. This is a welcome shift from what has been done in the past. This will also provide a clear pathway for our Arts programming and revitalize the Arts.

Evidence of practice:

- Refer to School Committee Documentation for SY 2022-2023
- MPS Weekly Administrative Team Meetings
- Continued utilization of NWEA Map Assessment Tool
- In process to select new ELA curriculum-almost completed
- Continuing implementation of new Math Curriculum
- School Committee approved Integrated Math Pathway for High School Students
- Continued partnership with HILL for Literacy and implementation of ECRI drawing on principles of the Science of Reading
- Support of Co-teaching for Special Education as well as for English Learners
- Supported the hiring of additional guidance and adjustment counselors, social workers and school psychologists
- Support of CCSR
- Utilization of MVTHS in practice: Computer Technology students working on the school website, Graphic Art students making Storyboards for park placements in collaboration with MFN, Early Education students providing Story, Song and Arts Program for the MFN, and Culinary students hosting the Medford Rotary Club's Monthly luncheon meeting
- Worked diligently with DESE/AIR for the Medford Public Schools District Review Standard II: Management and Operations Promotes the learning and growth of all students and the success of all staff by ensuring a safe, efficient, and effective learning environment, using resources to implement appropriate curriculum, staffing, and scheduling. (Focus Indicators: II-A Environment) Dr. Edouard-Vincent demonstrates solid management and operational skills.

Specific Evidence of practice:

- Re-Application of Statement of Interest (SOI) to the MSBA for SY 2023-2024
- Refer to School Committee Documentation for SY 2022-2023
- Transparent Budget Process with all administrators (COW)
- Math Curriculum Implementation
- Integrated Math Pathway to be initiated at MHS/MVTHS
- CCSR Initiatives
- Safety improvements made in many of the school parking lots via new traffic and parking marking, use of signage and orange cones, all to benefit our students, staff and families.
- Necessary asbestos removal work on the MHS overpasses
- Addressed pool issues, leakage & water temperature, as well as, and water issues/pipe damage work at MHS
- Addressed potholes in parking lots working with the City's DPW
- Worked on establishing a McGlynn Inclusive Playground Committee
- Worked with Sandy Hook Promise to teach students to Start with Hello, Say Something and implemented this year Say Something Anonymous Reporting, to empower students and staff to help create change and safer schools
- Settled MTA, Paras, Nurses, Building school contracts
- All schools are fully operational
- Worked with Medford Teachers Union to implement full day Wednesdays in our elementary schools in the 2023-2024 school year
- Implementation of 10-Point Action Plan at MHS for Safety, Transparency, Culture, Climate & Accountability
- All schools are fully staffed
- Implementation of new Principal Searches
- Screenagers Presentation
- MPS School Schedules
- MPS School Calendar

Standard III: Family and Community Engagement

Promotes the learning and growth of all students and the success of all staff through effective partnerships with families, community organizations, and other stakeholders that support the mission of the school and district.

(Focus Indicators: III-A Engagement, III- B Sharing Responsibility, & III-C Communication)

- Dr. Edouard-Vincent demonstrates solid family and community engagement skills.

Specific Evidence of practice:

- Refer to School Committee Documentation for SY 2022-2023
- Introduction of new more accessible Medford Public Schools Website & APP
- Continued involvement with the Medford SEPAC
- All levels-participation in school events
- Middle School Lottery (virtual)
- Middle School Open Houses (in-person)
- Elementary events (Field/Fun Day in-person)

- Kindergarten Open Houses (in-person)
- Medford Family Network (MFN)
- Women's History Month
- Haitian Flag Day Celebration-UPCOMING
- Japanese Learning School New Year's Program and Graduation Program
- Strong Middle School sports program
- Summer Fun Camp at the Missituk
- Department Head Meetings at City Hall
- Senior Prom - June 1, 2023 Upcoming
- Junior Prom - May 12, 2023 Upcoming
- West Medford Community Center Events (in-person): Legislative Breakfast
- McGlynn Elementary School Festival of the Arts
- MFN Parent Cafe
- Camp Mustang Upcoming
- Veteran Presentations to honor Veterans Day
- MPS High School Graduation - (Hormel Stadium June 7, 2023)
- Member of District Attorney Marian Ryan Anti-Bias/Anti-Hate Task Force
- New Color and Cords Newsletter
- Autism Communication Boards
- Fenway Football Game
- Blizzards Basketball Game at MHS
- Medford/Malden Transition Fair
- Support for Parents through Eliot Human Services
- ASD Parents/Caregivers Support Group
- Thanksgiving Flag Football Inclusive Team vs. Malden
- Junior Olympics Upcoming
- New Teacher/Staff Training
- Multi-District Job Fair with Chelsea, Revere, Everett, Winthrop
- College Information Session for students with IEP's & 504's
- Jumpstart Summer Music Camp Upcoming
- Building Bridges to Kindergarten
- Big Sister/Little Sister Program 9
- Jumpstart Read for the Record at the Missituk -"Nigel and the Moon"
- Project 351 Ambassadors (Middle School)
- MIDE Engineering continued partnership with McGlynn Middle School
- College & Career Fair
- 8th Grade Course Selection
- Board of Trustee Member for Melrose Wakefield Hospital (MWH)

Standard IV: Professional Culture

Promotes success for all students by nurturing and sustaining a school culture of reflective practice, high expectations, and continuous learning for staff.

(Focus Indicators: IV-A Commitment to High Standards, IV-B Cultural Proficiency, IV-F Managing Conflict)

- Dr. Edouard-Vincent demonstrates sound professional culture skills.

Specific evidence includes:

Evidence of proficient practice:

- Refer to School Committee Documentation for SY 2022-2023
- Refer to Medford Public Schools Website
- Supporting CCSR initiatives
- District Professional Development Days (virtual)
- Commitment toward increasing cultural proficiency, promoting Anti-racist, Anti-Bias, & Anti-Hate
- Promoting Mustang Way and Mustang Pride (virtual)
- Ribas Training - Professional Development
- School climate survey at MHS Upcoming on 5.11.2023
- Listening Sessions at MHS

Superintendent's Final Summary Comments:

She shares that she is a proud superintendent. This year has been a year of many positive events and some equally challenging moments. As a community we have mobilized and we are ready to continue to make the Medford Public Schools the best district in the State. Although we have three principal searches taking place, she is confident that this inclusive process will yield strong leaders for our vacancies. She remains committed to Achievement, Collaboration, Equity, and Support (A.C.E.S.) as the four guiding pillars that are the basis of her educational leadership. As an educator, she remains committed to the achievement and academic outcomes of ALL of our students. As the graduation season is upon us and seniors are moving on to college and careers, she wants to stress the importance of academic achievements for ALL of our learners.

In closing, Superintendent Edouard-Vincent reiterates all this work cannot be done without the support of a team. She wholeheartedly thanks the support of my senior leadership team and the administrators who manage all the schools. This takes collaboration and coordination of teams, administrators, teachers, and staff to create the best learning environments for ALL of our students. She looks forward to our continued partnership for children.

Overall Rating: Proficient

Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Ruseau; seconded by Member Graham

Motion Carries: 7/0

Meeting adjourns at 6:05pm